

ARIN 5104: Artificial Intelligence Ethics (Spring 2026)

Group Project

Objective

Students will engage in a debate setting to explore the ethical implications of autonomous vehicles in real-world applications. By fostering a dynamic and interactive learning environment, students will develop critical thinking and argumentation skills while gaining a richer understanding of AI ethics and its complexities through exploring diverse perspectives.

Group Size and Formation

Each group consists of 2-3 students. You may form your own group or request assistance for group formation.

Project Components

Role Assignment:

- Each group member represents a different viewpoint, which may differ from their personal beliefs. It is up to you how to assign roles within your group.
- One student will argue in favor of autonomous vehicles as a proponent, focusing on their benefits and potential positive impacts.
- Another student will argue against autonomous vehicles as an opponent, highlighting ethical concerns, risks, and negative consequences.
- If a third member is included, they will act as a neutral party, summarizing arguments and identifying gaps to facilitate further investigation.

Research and Preparation:

- Each student will conduct research to support their assigned viewpoints, exploring a range of ethical perspectives to enhance the subsequent debate.
- Research should identify key ethical issues, prepare arguments and counterarguments, and propose mitigation strategies relevant to the assigned viewpoint.
- The arguments should ideally be backed by real cases from your home country or a location you are familiar with.

Debate and Deliberation:

- Each group will arrange a debate to systematically discuss their arguments.
- Each side will present its main arguments, followed by responses to opposing arguments.
- This is followed by detailed discussions to allow for cross-arguments and questions.
- Possible outcomes may include consensus, unchanged viewpoints, or a spectrum in between.

Oral Presentation or Debate Video:

- Each group is required to record an oral presentation or debate as a video of approximately **10 minutes** in length.
- While the format of the oral presentation or debate is up to you, you should begin by introducing the name and assigned role of each group member clearly. In addition, all group members should remain visible throughout the video.
- The video should showcase the main arguments, counterarguments, and discussions from your debate.
- The video aims to encourage effective communication skills and reduce over-reliance on AI tools.

Project Report:

- The report should summarize research findings, arguments, and strategies, along with reflections on the debate and the video presentation.
- It is up to you how to organize the materials clearly for presentation in the report, ensuring that all group members contribute equally to the report preparation.
- The report should be **2,000-2,500 words** long, with a clear word count indicated at the beginning. In addition to the textual content, figures and tables may be included to enhance comprehension.
- You are expected to try your best to ensure that the workload is shared evenly among all group members. If the workload deviation between members exceeds 5%, it should be stated clearly in the report by listing the contribution of each member to the project in percentage (e.g., 55% by A and 45% by B).

Submission Guidelines

Submit your project report in a single PDF file and the video presentation in a single MP4 file (no more than **500 MB**) via the Canvas course site. One member of each project group will submit the report and video on behalf of the group, and all group members' names should be clearly listed at the beginning of the report. Late submissions will incur a penalty of 1% of the total points for every hour late, up to a maximum of **12 hours**. Being late for a fraction of an hour is considered a full hour.

Grading Rubric

Criteria	Excellent (3 points)	Good (2 points)	Satisfactory (1 point)	Unsatisfactory (0 points)
Research Depth	Comprehensive research with diverse sources and perspectives.	Good research with some variety in sources.	Basic level of research with limited perspectives.	Minimal or no research conducted.
Argument Quality	Strong, well-structured arguments with clear evidence and counterarguments.	Clear arguments with some evidence, but may lack depth.	Arguments are present but poorly structured or supported.	Weak or unclear arguments with no evidence.
Role Fulfillment	All members effectively fulfill their assigned roles and contribute equally.	Most members fulfil roles, with minor imbalances in contribution.	Some roles are fulfilled, but contribution is uneven.	Roles are not fulfilled, or contribution is very uneven.
Presentation Quality	Engaging and professional presentation; all members visible and articulate.	Clear presentation; most members visible and articulate.	Presentation lacks clarity or engagement; some members not visible.	Poor presentation; members not visible or engaged.
Report Clarity	Well-organized, clear report with logical flow and minimal errors.	Mostly clear report, but may have minor organizational issues or errors.	Report is unclear or poorly organized, with several errors.	Unclear, disorganized report with numerous errors.
Reflection and Insights	Thoughtful reflections on the debate and presentation, demonstrating deep understanding.	Good reflections, showing some understanding of the debate and presentation.	Basic reflections with limited insights.	Little to no reflection provided.
Adherence to Guidelines	Fully meets all submission guidelines (format, length, etc.).	Meets most submission guidelines with minor issues.	Meets some guidelines but has significant issues.	Fails to meet submission guidelines.

Total points: 21

The grading rubric is designed to evaluate group submissions based on several key criteria. Each criterion will be assessed on a scale of 0 to 3 points, with specific descriptors for each level of performance. The final score will be the sum of the points awarded across all criteria.

Grading Scale:

- **Excellent (18-21 points):** Meets all criteria at the highest level, demonstrating exceptional understanding of the topic, strong arguments, effective role fulfillment, and high-quality presentation and report.
- **Good (14-17 points):** Meets most criteria well, showing solid understanding and engagement with the topic, along with clear arguments and a mostly effective presentation and report.
- **Satisfactory (10-13 points):** Meets some criteria, reflecting a basic understanding of the topic with limited engagement, poorly structured arguments, and an unclear presentation and report.
- **Unsatisfactory (0-9 points):** Fails to meet the basic criteria, showing minimal understanding of the topic, weak arguments, and a lack of clarity in both presentation and report.